K-12 Health Education Instructional Resources Recommendation



PORTLAND
Public Schools

Board of Directors Presentation
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Assistant Director Health & PE
May 26, 2026


PPS
TOGETHER,
WE RISE
WITH EXCELLENCE. WITH PURPOSE.

Agenda

- Background & Purpose
- Participants
- Selection Process
- Recommendation
- Fiscal Impact
- Implementation Plan



Background and Purpose

- Four-year process engaging staff, students, and community stakeholders
- Aligns with Oregon Health Education Standards (2025) and all State Laws and Mandates (e.g., Division 22)
- Supports PPS priority for High Quality Instructional Materials
- Focus on comprehensive, skills-based, inclusive health education
- Sub-Content Areas:
  - Mental & Emotional Health
  - Food, Nutrition & Physical Activity
  - Substance Use Prevention
  - Comprehensive Sexuality Education
  - Violence Prevention



Adoption Process Overview - 5 Year Cycle

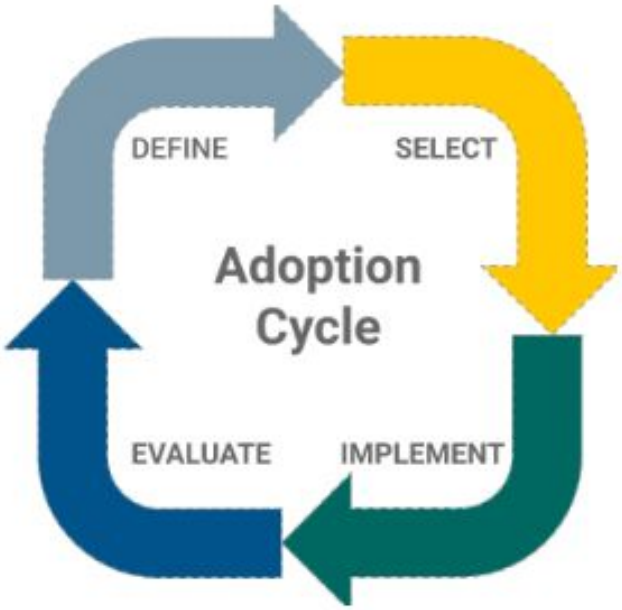
2022-2026

Step 1: Define

- Internal program evaluations
- Position papers
- Instructional materials evaluation rubric

Step 2: Select

- AIR Committee
- Vendor presentations
- Field testing
- Feedback and recommendations



2026-2031

Step 3 & 4: Implement & Evaluate

- Teacher professional learning
- Materials distribution (IRC)
- Ongoing data collection (quantitative and qualitative)

PPS Adoption Toolkit

Grade Level and Standards Aligned

Developmentally Appropriate, Laws, Mandates, and Standards Aligned District Materials



Title IX & the Oregon Equality Act



Erin's Law



Violence Prevention



Menstrual Dignity Act (MDA)



Every Student Belongs Rule



Comprehensive Sexuality Education



Adi's Act



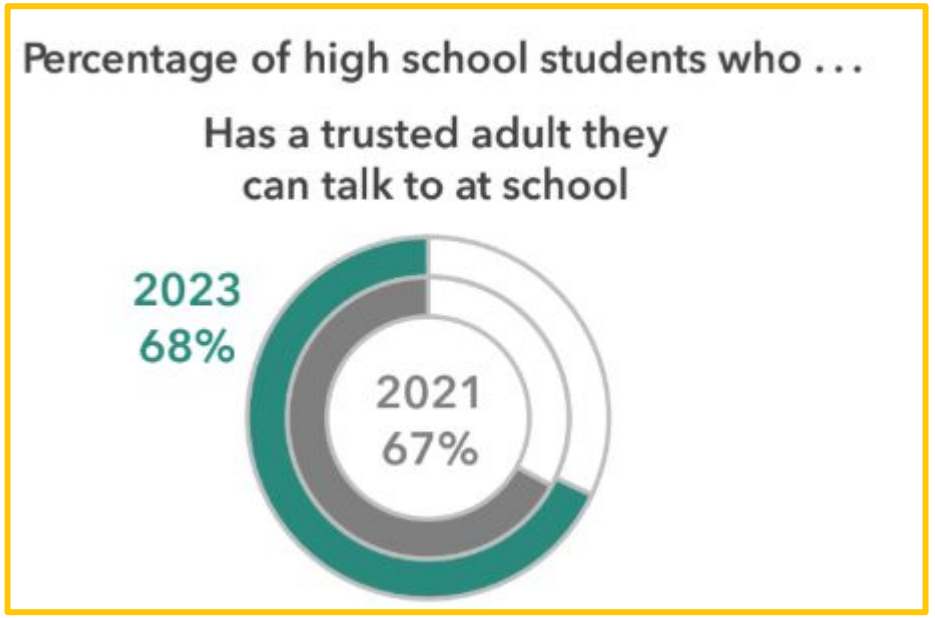
Healthy Teens Relationship Act



Substance Use, Misuse, & Abuse Prevention

Background and Purpose: Limits

- No single comprehensive health textbook meets state standards
- Need for flexible, responsive curriculum aligned to student data
- Reliance on, and collaboration with, specialized public health organizations for content



Data collected in 2023 from all PPS high schools using the Youth Risk Behavior Survey. Students report on health factors such as substance use, school safety, and nutrition. HPE uses this data to inform curricula procurement.

Participants

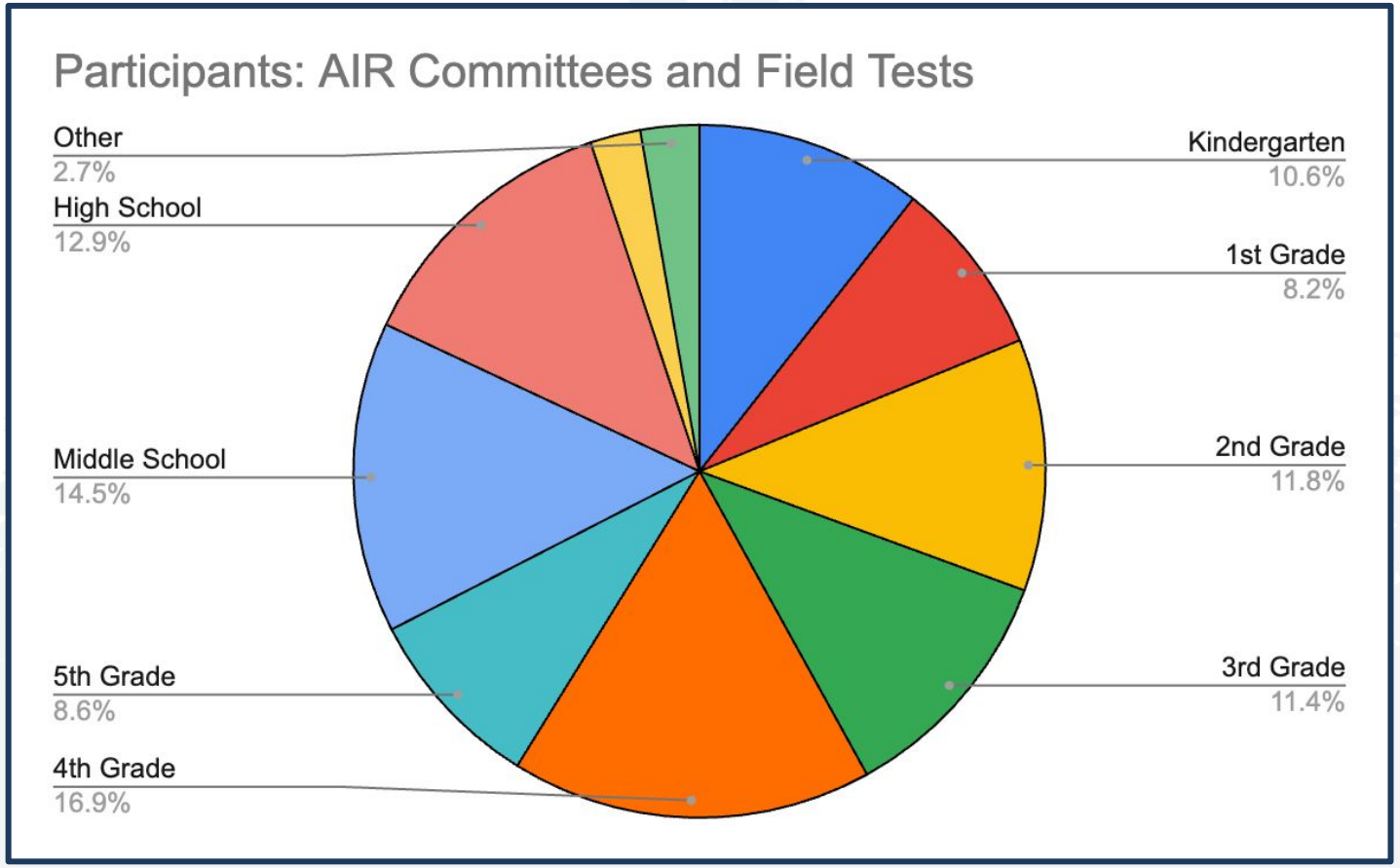
- Health & Physical Education Team
- AIR Committees
- Teachers (Field Testers)
- Students (Field Testers)
- Community Stakeholders
- Village Table
- Public health organizations and curriculum partners



Students giving feedback on the nutrition field test materials

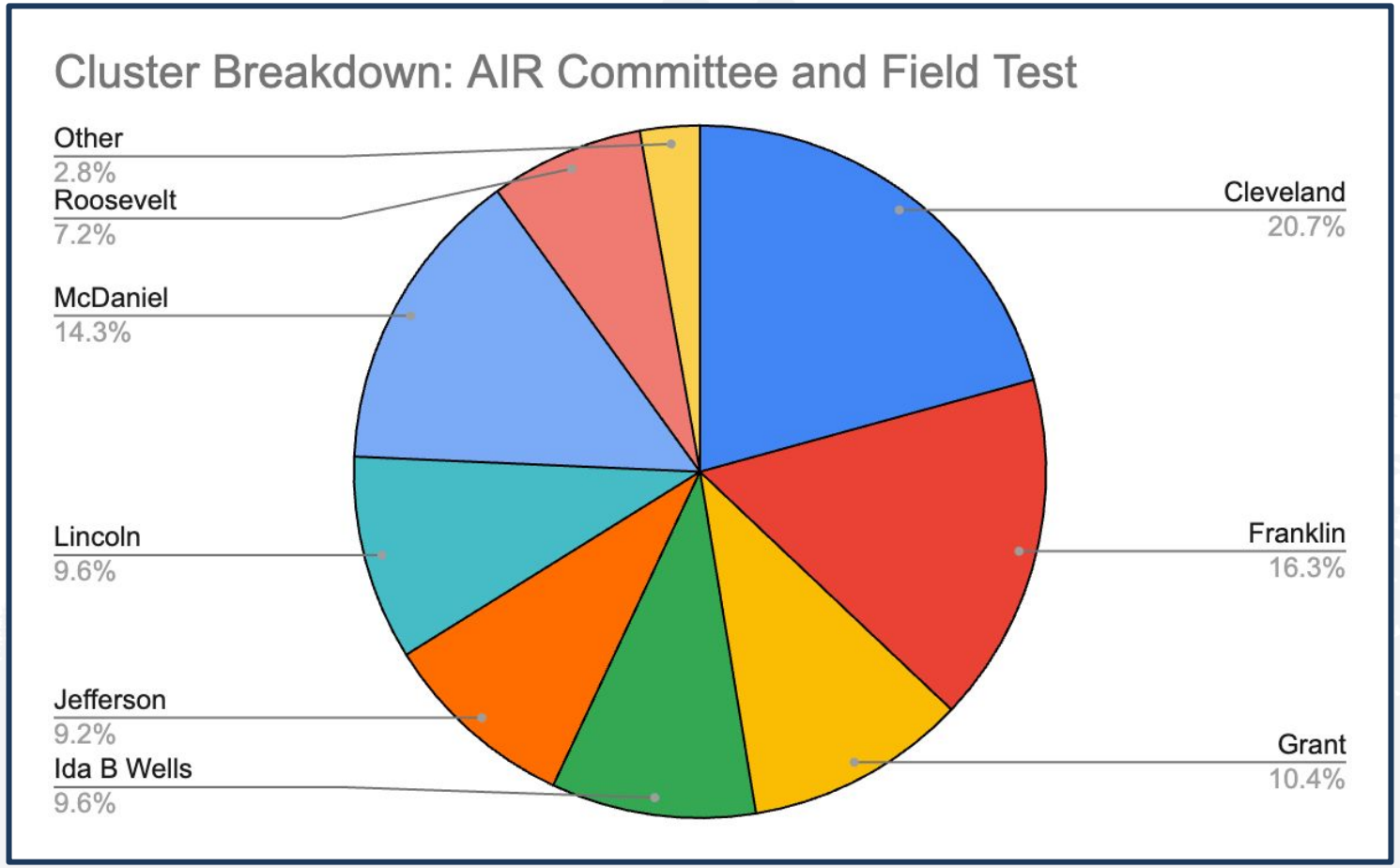
Participants: Grade / Role

Total Participants Across AIR and FT	
Grade/Role	**Participants**
Kindergarten	27
1st Grade	21
2nd Grade	30
3rd Grade	29
4th Grade	43
5th Grade	22
Middle School	37
High School	33
SPED	6
Other	7
TOTAL	**255**



Cluster Breakdown

Total AIR and FT Across Cluster	
Cluster	**Participants**
Cleveland	52
Franklin	41
Grant	26
Ida B Wells	24
Jefferson	23
Lincoln	24
McDaniel	36
Roosevelt	18
Other	7



Celebrating Participants and Stakeholders

- Hundreds of educators, students and community members engaged with cross-grade and cross-cluster participation
- Transparent process with open house and listening sessions at the Community Engagement Night hosted at the PEC in Fall of 2025
- Commitment to inclusive, community-informed decision making



Selection Process

- Review of vendors and existing curricula, including comprehensive health textbooks
- Field testing of standards-aligned instructional materials
- Feedback from educators and community
- Alignment to laws, standards, and student needs



Adoption Timeline

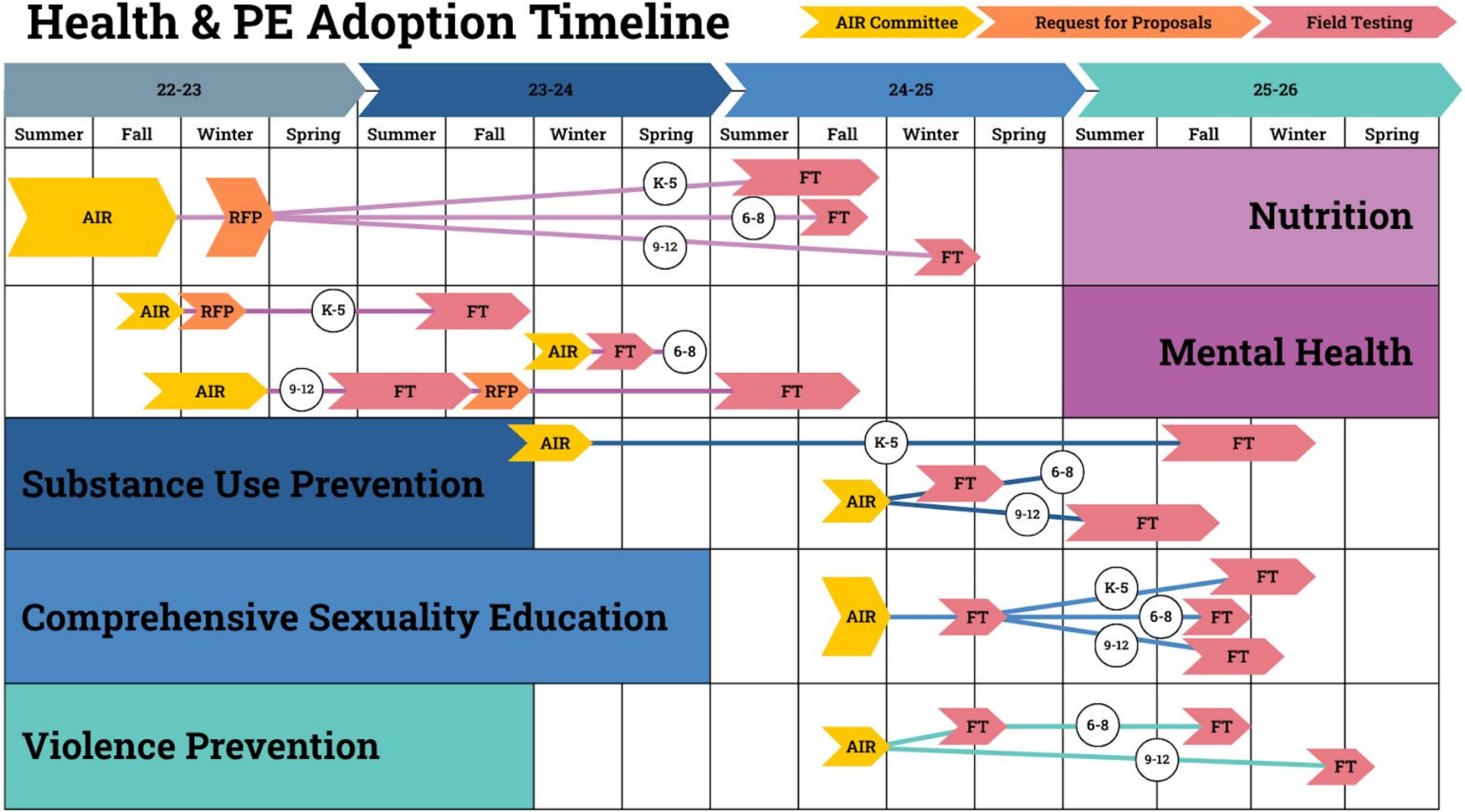
2022-2026: Multi-Year Adoption

- Concurrent evaluation and piloting of multiple programs
- Phased rollout across K–12
- Integration with existing instructional practices
- Ongoing evaluation, refinement and Professional Development

Note: Extended timeline for Mental Health and Nutrition due to curriculum development specific to PPS student needs

Mental Health : 2022-2025
Nutrition: 2022-2025
Substance Use Prevention: 2024-2026
Comprehensive Sexuality Education: 2024-2026
Violence Prevention: 2024-2026

Health & PE Adoption Timeline



Field Tested Materials

Selected by the HAPE AIR Committees

Materials from organizations such as:

- Advocates for Youth
- Stanford REACH Lab
- BeReal USA
- ETR HealthSmart
- Cairn Guidance
- ODHS
- NEST Foundation

We are proud of the wide variety of materials, chosen with consideration for accuracy and efficacy, that were assessed by our teachers and students.

Recommended Materials

Recommended for Adoption: Participants approved these instructional materials for adoption

K–5 Substance Use Prevention: 5th grade teachers recommend Stanford REACH Lab programs, while K-4 materials from multiple vendors showed gaps in standards alignment and consistency. The team recommends issuing an RFP to develop cohesive, standards-aligned curriculum for K-5.

Sub-Content Area	K-5	6-8	9-12
Mental & Emotional Health	Cairn Guidance	Cairn Guidance Signs of Suicide	Cairn Guidance Signs of Suicide
Food, Nutrition, & Physical Activity	Cairn Guidance	Cairn Guidance Let's Eat!	Cairn Guidance
Substance Use Prevention	5th Grade: Stanford REACH	Project ALERT HealthSmart	Stanford REACH: Safety First
Comprehensive Sexuality Education	Advocates for Youth: *Rights, Respect, Responsibility*	ODHS: *My Future-My Choice*	Advocates for Youth: *Rights, Respect, Responsibility*
Violence Prevention	Already Adopted in 2023	ODHS: *My Future-My Choice*	Nest Foundation: *You Belong Here*

Recommendations

The Why:

All materials recommended by participants:

- Meet legal requirements and mandates
- Align with district priorities and state standards
- Are ready to use with minimal adaptation or supplementation
- Supports whole child development
- Improves school climate, attendance, and student outcomes

Fiscal Impact

Grade Band	Unit/topic	Item	Vendor / Contract	Estimated Cost
HS	Violence Prevention	Digital Curriculum Access	NEST	$350,000 (5 year)
MS	Substance Use	Digital Curriculum Access	ETR	$410,891.78 (5 year)
MS	Comprehensive Sex Education and Violence Prevention	Digital Curriculum Access	ODHS (*My Future-My Choice*)	$175,000 for curriculum development
ES	Growth and Development	Digital Curriculum Access	Advocates for Youth	$11,700 for Graphic Design to align all K-5 lesson plans to the most recent layout
ES	Growth and Development	Professional Development	Advocates for Youth	$59,450.00:
TOTAL COST				**$1,007,041.78**

Grant Funded Initiatives

These adoptions were supported by funds from the CDC and Kaiser Permanente at no cost to PPS

Subject	Gradeband	Materials	Cost covered by Grant Funds
Mental Health	K-5	Cairn Guidance	$93,000
Nutrition	K-12	Cairn Guidance	$50,000
Total			$143,000

Open Source Materials

These adoptions were free.

Subject	Gradeband	Materials	
Mental Health	4-12	*Amazing Me; Riding the Waves; Erika's Lighthouse*	**NO COST**
Substance Use Prevention	6th; 9-12	*Project Alert*; *Safety First*	
Comprehensive Sex Ed	K-5; 9-12	*Rights, Respect, Responsibility*	

Implementation Plan

Rollout

- Phased implementation across grade bands
- Integration into existing health instruction and course maps

Professional Development (PD)

- Curriculum-aligned training modules
- Ongoing educator support

Current Use

- Many materials already piloted and used in classrooms
- Teachers familiar with instructional approaches
- Positive feedback for all rolled-out materials.



An Investment in Student Health

Ready for Impact

- Phased rollout ensures thoughtful, sustainable implementation
- Materials already piloted so teachers are prepared and confident

Supported Educators

- Ongoing, curriculum-aligned professional learning
- Continuous support for high-quality instruction

Meaningful Results

- Equips students with skills for living healthy lives
- Strengthens belonging, safety, and school climate
- Advances district goals for attendance, achievement, and well-being

Systems Built to Last

- Standards-aligned, adaptable, and responsive to student needs
- Grounded in community voice and educator expertise

This is not just a curriculum adoption. This is an investment in the health, safety, and future of every student.

Questions?

